Federal Government	Unitary Government
3. Division of powers between the national and regional government	3. No division of powers. All powers are vested in the national government
4. Supremacy of the Constitution	4. Constitution may be supreme (Japan) or may not be supreme (Britain)
5. Rigid Constitution	5. Constitution may be rigid (France) or flexible (Britain)
6. Independent judiciary	6. Judiciary may be independent or may not be independent
7. Bicameral legislature	7. Legislature may be bicameral (Britain) or unicameral (China)

The Constitution of India provides for a federal system of government in the country. The framers adopted the federal system due to two main reasons—the large size of the country and its socio-cultural diversity. They realised that the federal system not only ensures the efficient governance of the country but also reconciles national unity with regional autonomy.

However, the term 'federation' has no where been used in the Constitution. Instead, Article 1 of the Constitution describes India as a 'Union of States'. According to Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, the phrase 'Union of States' has been preferred to 'Federation of States' to indicate two things: **(i)** the Indian federation is not the result of an agreement among the states like the American federation; and **(ii)** the states have no right to secede from the federation. The federation is a union because it is indestructible.[1]

The Indian federal system is based on the 'Canadian model' and not on the 'American model'. The 'Canadian model' differs fundamentally from the 'American model' in so far as it establishes a very strong centre. The Indian federation resembles the Canadian federation **(i)** in its formation (i.e., by way of disintegration); **(ii)** in its preference to the term 'Union' (the Canadian federation is also called a 'Union'); and **(iii)** in its centralising tendency (i.e., vesting more powers in the centre vis-a-vis the states).

FEDERAL FEATURES OF THE CONSTITUTION

The federal features of the Constitution of India are explained below:

1. Dual Polity

The Constitution establishes a dual polity consisting of the Union at the Centre and the states at the periphery. Each is endowed with sovereign powers to be exercised in the field assigned to them respectively by the Constitution. The Union government deals with matters of national importance like defence, foreign affairs, currency, communication and so on. The state governments, on the other hand,